

9th Grade: Building Your Foundation

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Freshman year is about habits and curiosity, not deadlines. These are the moments to plan for together.

SEP
1

Grades start counting now

Freshman grades are part of the GPA colleges see. Help your student build good study habits early.

SEP
15

Talk about why college

Ask: what do you think college is for, and is it worth it for you? No pressure, just curiosity.

OCT
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Meet the counselor and learn A-G

Introduce yourself to the counselor. Ask which courses (the A-G list) keep UC and CSU options open.

NOV
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Explore one or two real interests

Encourage activities your student actually enjoys. Depth beats a long list of clubs.

JAN
15

Bust the cost myth early

Most families overestimate college cost. Look up one school's net price together so sticker shock does not steer decisions.

FEB
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Start a small savings habit

Even a small automatic monthly amount adds up over four years. Anything is better than nothing.

APR
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Aim for some rigor next year

When choosing 10th-grade classes, encourage one challenging course your student can handle. Growth matters more than a perfect GPA.

JUN
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Make the summer count

A job, volunteering, or a free program helps your student explore interests and build a story for later.